A Complete Small Group Study Resource

Jude 24–25

The Doxology of Confidence: He Is Able

Small Group Bible Study Series · Jude

Source: The Gospel Vault

Editor: The Gospel Vault

① TEXT	② DEVOTIONAL	③ COMMENTARY	④ SELF-STUDY GUIDE
Foundation	Personal prep	Teacher preparation	Group meeting
Everyone	All group members	Teacher / Leader	Small group

① BIBLICAL TEXT

NASB · Jude 24–25

24 *Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling, and to make you stand in the presence of His glory blameless with great joy,*

25 *to the only God our Savior, through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty, dominion and authority, before all time and now and forever. Amen.*

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② DEVOTIONAL

Personal preparation · All group members

> *"Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling, and to make you stand in the presence of His glory blameless with great joy…"*

After weeks of warnings and instructions — contend, build, pray, keep, rescue — Jude ends not with one more command but with praise. Two verses that lift every eye off the threat and onto the One who is able. That is not an accident. It is the deepest pastoral move in the letter.

He is able to keep you from stumbling. He will make you stand in the presence of His glory, blameless. And He will do it with great joy — not grim relief, but overflowing gladness.

You are not being kept because you have contended well. You are being kept because He is able. The whole letter rests here.

Reflect

1. Where are you treating the outcome of your Christian life as dependent on your faithfulness rather than on His ability?
2. The word “blameless” describes you at the last day. What does it do to your deepest failure to sit with that word?
3. Having walked through Jude, what has changed most in how you see the One who is keeping you?

He is able. That was true on the first page. It is truer now.

③ COMMENTARY

Teacher preparation resource · Full text organized under outline headings

> **Proposition.** Jude's letter, with all its warnings, rests on one fact: God is able to keep believers from stumbling and to make them stand before His glory blameless with great joy — and to Him belong glory, majesty, dominion, and authority forever.

Introduction — When a Battle Cry Ends in Worship

There is a structural surprise at the end of Jude that is easy to miss on first reading and impossible to miss on a second. The letter that began with a battle cry — "contend earnestly for the faith" (v. 3) — does not end in a battle. It does not end with a verdict on the false teachers, a last instruction, or a final appeal. It ends in a doxology: two verses of praise so exalted that the church has used them in worship for twenty centuries.

That structural choice is a theological statement. Jude has given his community everything it needs for the threat: the precedents of history (vv. 5–11), the portraits of the intruders (vv. 12–16), the prescription for faithful life (vv. 17–23). All of it was necessary. And then, having equipped them, he lifts their eyes — not to the threat, not to their own performance, but to the One who is able.

For the preacher, this is where the series must linger longest. The warnings are real, and the call to contend is real. But neither is the deepest word. The deepest word is what God is able to do, and has promised to do, for people who are called, beloved, and kept.

I. The Ability: He Is Able to Keep You from Stumbling – v. 24a

The doxology opens by naming God through His ability before any other attribute: "to Him who is able." Out of all that Jude could say about God at the close of this letter — His holiness, His love, His justice — he leads with what the community most needs after twenty-three verses of urgency: the ability of the One who is holding them through it.

The specific ability is the one that answers the letter's anxiety: "to keep you from stumbling." The verb is *phylassō* — to guard, to watch over vigilantly. It is a different word from the *tēreō* of verses 1, 6, 13, and 21, but it points the same direction, and Jude may use it here as a fresh, climactic way of saying the same thing. "Stumbling" translates *aptaistous*, a word that appears only here in the New Testament. It is built from a negative prefix and *ptaiō*, to stumble or fall: literally "not-stumbled." It is the word for secure footing.

What does that mean after twenty-three verses that have described drift, damage, and departure? It means the final, irreversible stumble — the fall that would end in the black darkness reserved for the wandering stars (v. 13) — is not available to those held by this God. Believers do stumble in other ways: they sin, they waver, they go through seasons of weakness. First John 1:9 gives the remedy for those stumbles. But the God who is able keeps them from the fall that ends the climb.

This is where Free Grace and Reformed readers differ most clearly. Reformed theology agrees that believers will reach glory, but it grounds that certainty in the perseverance of the saints: the elect will necessarily persevere, and perseverance is the evidence and means of

their keeping.[1] The Free Grace reading rests on the words Jude uses: God is *able*, and the keeping is His accomplishment, grounded in His promise and power, not in the quality or consistency of the believer's performance.[2] The same God who placed believers in the keeping of verse 1 will complete the presentation of verse 24.

A climber on a hard ascent will slip. The hand loses its grip, the foot misses its hold. But if he is tied to a rope held by someone stronger above him, the slip does not become a fall. The rope catches him. He hangs, recovers, and climbs on. The God who is able is the one holding the rope.

The New Testament says this in many ways. Jesus says of His sheep, "no one will snatch them out of My hand" (John 10:28–29), and Paul writes that "He who began a good work in you will perfect it until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6). Jude's doxology is one more voice in a chorus. The Reformed reading hears these promises as promises to the elect who persevere; we hear them as promises to every believer, resting on the One who makes them. Either way, the person making the promise is the One who is able.

II. The Goal: To Make You Stand Blameless with Great Joy – v. 24b

God does not only keep His people from the final fall. He has a destination for them: "to make you stand in the presence of His glory blameless with great joy." Three elements deserve attention.

A. In the presence of His glory

The phrase situates the standing in God's own unveiled, unmediated glory. This is not a ceremony in an anteroom. It is the throne room — the glory before which Isaiah cried "Woe is me, for I am ruined!" (Isaiah 6:5) and John fell as a dead man (Revelation 1:17). Before that glory, God will make His people *stand*. The verb is causative: He is the One who makes them stand. They stand not by their own righteousness but because the One who is able has brought them there.

B. Blameless

Amōmos is the word the Greek Old Testament uses for the sacrificial animal without blemish — perfectly acceptable for presentation to a holy God. What mattered was the condition of the animal as it was presented. Jude says that God will present His people — the same community that has been wavering and contending and pulling one another from fires — as blameless. Not despite their failures; having brought them through to that state. Paul uses the same word of the church's final condition in Ephesians 5:27. The blamelessness is God's accomplishment from first to last.

This is the anchor of assurance in the letter: it rests entirely on divine ability and grace, not on how well the believer has persevered.

Paul says it just as plainly to the Thessalonians: "May the God of peace Himself sanctify you entirely… Faithful is He who calls you, and He will also bring it to pass" (1 Thessalonians 5:23–24). Notice where the confidence rests: not on the believers' steadiness but on the faithfulness of the One who called them. What He starts, He finishes. And what He finishes is a people He can set before His own glory without shame.

C. With great joy

Agalliasis is not quiet satisfaction or solemn acceptance. It is exuberant, overflowing gladness — the word used of the unborn John leaping at Mary's greeting (Luke 1:44), of the early church eating together "with gladness and simplicity of heart" (Acts 2:46), and of the joy "inexpressible and full of glory" of believers loving a Christ they have not seen (1 Peter 1:8). The presentation of God's people before His glory will be attended by exultation.

Whose joy is it? The grammar does not say, and the best reading includes both: the joy of the believers arriving home and the joy of the God who kept them all the way to the door. The father who ran down the road to meet the prodigal, who fell on his neck and called for the robe and the ring and the fattened calf (Luke 15:20–24), is the nearest human picture of what *agalliasis* will look like.

Scripture does speak of God's own joy over His people. "The LORD your God is in your midst, a victorious warrior. He will exult over you with joy, He will be quiet in His love, He will rejoice over you with shouts of joy" (Zephaniah 3:17). Jesus says there is joy in heaven over one sinner who repents (Luke 15:7). If that is how He rejoices over a single sinner turning, what must His joy be on the day He sets the whole company of the kept before His glory?

III. The Doxology: Glory, Majesty, Dominion, Authority – v. 25

A. The only God our Savior, through Jesus Christ our Lord

The doxology is addressed to "the only God our Savior." The Pastoral Epistles often call the Father "Savior" (1 Timothy 1:1; Titus 1:3; 3:4), and here the title ties the work of saving to the God who keeps. The phrase "through Jesus Christ our Lord" reminds us how the keeping and the presentation are accomplished: in and through Him. Jude's letter began with "kept for Jesus Christ" and ends with "through Jesus Christ our Lord." Christ is the beginning and the channel of everything God does for His own.

B. Four attributes, in two pairs

The first pair — glory (*doxa*) and majesty (*megalōsynē*) — describes what God is in Himself. These are qualities of His nature, not achievements. No crisis of the church has diminished them. The second pair — dominion (*kratos*) and authority (*exousia*) — describes what God wields: the irresistible power that accomplishes what it sets out to do, and the rightful authority to exercise it. Together they say that God's keeping is not merely well-intentioned. It is operationally guaranteed. The gap between "able" and "done" does not exist for this God.

The Old Testament has its own doxologies with the same shape. David prays, "Yours, O LORD, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the victory and the majesty, indeed everything that is in the heavens and the earth; Yours is the dominion, O LORD, and You exalt Yourself as head over all" (1 Chronicles 29:11). Jude joins that long line of worshipers and adds what the cross has made possible: God is "our Savior, through Jesus Christ our Lord."

C. Before all time and now and forever

The temporal formula is the fullest in the New Testament: “before all time and now and forever.” God’s glory and authority pre-existed the crisis, fill the moment in which the community is contending, and extend through every age to come. The crisis is real, but it is contained within a much larger reality. The “now” of threat is held within “forever,” not the other way around. The “Amen” that closes the letter is the community’s spoken assent: yes, this is true, let it be so.

Conclusion — The Letter’s Deepest Word

The bookend structure is the letter’s main architectural feature. It opens: “called, beloved in God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ” (v. 1). It closes: “able to keep you from stumbling… to make you stand… blameless with great joy” (v. 24). Everything between — the battle cry, the precedents, the portraits, the four disciplines, the rescue postures — is held inside those two declarations of divine keeping. The bookends do not move.

The community did not earn the opening, and it will not earn the closing. The same divine ability that placed them in the keeping of verse 1 will accomplish the presentation of verse 24. The contending they are called to is real and urgent — but it is the contending of kept people, not of people fighting for a future they are unsure is theirs.

Go and build. Go and pray. Keep yourselves in His love and wait for His mercy. Reach out to the wavering, the endangered, and the stained. Contend earnestly for the faith once for all handed down. And do it all knowing the outcome rests not on the quality of your contending but on the ability of the One for whom you contend. To Him be glory, majesty, dominion, and authority, before all time and now and forever.

Amen.

Sources and Notes

1. Reformed treatment of perseverance and glorification: Louis Berkhof, *Systematic Theology* (Grand Rapids: Eerdmans), on perseverance of the saints; Thomas R. Schreiner and Ardel B. Caneday, *The Race Set Before Us* (Downers Grove, IL: InterVarsity Press, 2001); Thomas R. Schreiner, *1, 2 Peter, Jude*, New American Commentary (Nashville: Broadman & Holman, 2003), on Jude 24–25.

2. Free Grace treatment of assurance: Robert N. Wilkin, *Confident in Christ* (Denton, TX: Grace Evangelical Society, 1999); Charles C. Bing, *Simply by Grace* (Grand Rapids: Kregel, 2009); Zane C. Hodges, *Grace in Eclipse* (Denton, TX: Grace Evangelical Society, 2007); Robert N. Wilkin, ed., *The Grace New Testament Commentary* (2010), on Jude.

3. Word studies: Blue Letter Bible lexicon entries G1410 (*dynamai*), G5442 (*phylassō*), G679 (*aptaistos*), G2476 (*histēmi*), G2714 (*katenōpion*), G299 (*amōmos*), G20 (*agalliasis*), G3441 (*monos*), G4990 (*sōtēr*), G1391 (*doxa*), G3172 (*megalōsynē*), G2904 (*kratos*), G1849 (*exousia*), G165 (*aiōn*), G281 (*amēn*); BDAG, 3rd ed.

4. On the doxology and its use in worship, and on the Greek text of v. 25 (including the longer reading “before all time”): see the NET Bible translators’ notes on Jude 25 and Thomas L. Constable, *Expository Notes on Jude*, planobiblechapel.org/tcon/notes/.

④ SELF-STUDY GUIDE

For use during the group meeting · Focused on the commentary text

Greek Word Study

Verse	Greek Word / English	Strong's # / Translit. / Form	Definition & Significance
v.24	**δυναμένῳ** to Him who is able	G1410 dynamenō Pres. Mid. Ptc. Dat. Sg. Masc.	STR: to be able, powerful. Significance: God named by His ability first. The attribute that answers the letter's anxiety.
v.24	**φυλάξαι** to keep	G5442 phylaxai Aor. Act. Inf.	STR: to guard, watch over. Significance: a fresh, climactic word for keeping, beside the *tēreō* of vv. 1, 6, 13, 21.
v.24	**ἁπταίστους** without stumbling	G679 aptaistous Adj.-Acc. Pl. Masc.	Only here in the NT. Negative prefix + *ptaiō*: "not-stumbled." Secure footing — the final stumble is not available to the kept.
v.24	**στῆσαι** to make stand	G2476 stēsai Aor. Act. Inf.	STR: to cause to stand. Significance: causative — God makes them stand. They stand because He brings them there.
v.24	**κατενώπιον** in the presence of	G2714 katenōpion Prep.	STR: before the face of. Significance: directly before, face to face. The throne-room reality of His unveiled glory.
v.24	**ἀμώμους** blameless	G299 amōmous Adj.-Acc. Pl. Masc.	STR: unblemished. LXX: the sacrificial term (Lev. 1:3). Significance: perfect acceptability before God's holiness; His accomplishment, not their record (cf. Eph. 5:27).
v.24	**ἀγαλλιάσει** great joy	G20 agalliasei N-Dat. Sg. Fem.	STR: exultation. Significance: exuberant, overflowing gladness (Luke 1:44; Acts 2:46), never quiet relief.
v.25	**μόνῳ θεῷ σωτῆρι** the only God our Savior	G3441 / G2316 / G4990 monō theō sōtēri Adj./N-Dat. Sg. Masc.	Significance: God as the sole Savior. Ties the Savior's work to the God who keeps.
v.25	**δόξα** glory	G1391 doxa N-Nom. Sg. Fem.	STR: glory, splendor. Significance: God's intrinsic splendor — what He is in Himself.
v.25	**μεγαλωσύνη** majesty	G3172 megalōsynē N-Nom. Sg. Fem.	STR: greatness. Significance: used only 3× in NT (Heb. 1:3; 8:1; Jude 25), always of God's greatness. With *doxa*, it describes His nature.
v.25	**κράτος** dominion	G2904 kratos N-Nom. Sg. Neut.	STR: strength, might. Significance: the effectual, irresistible power that accomplishes what it sets out to do.
v.25	**ἐξουσία** authority	G1849 exousia N-Nom. Sg. Fem.	STR: authority, right. Significance: the rightful authority to exercise that power — right and might, together.

Verse	Greek Word / English	Strong's # / Translit. / Form	Definition & Significance
v.25	αἰῶνος time, age	G165 aiōnos N-Gen. Sg. Masc.	STR: age. Significance: “before all time and now and forever” — the fullest temporal formula in the NT.

Cases: Nom. · Gen. · Dat. · Acc. · Voc. | Number: Sg. · Pl. | Gender: Masc. · Fem. · Neut. | Verb Mood: Ind. · Impv. · Subj. · Opt. · Inf. · Ptc. | Tense: Pres. · Imperf. · Fut. · Aor. · Perf. · Plpf. | Voice: Act. · Mid. · Pass. | Person: 1st/2nd/3rd Sg./Pl.

Study Questions

Part 1 — From the Commentary

Question	Answer
Why does Jude open the doxology with God’s ability?	The letter’s warnings have raised the question of what holds believers. “Able” directly answers that question and calls attention to God, not the believer’s performance.
What does *aptaistous* (“without stumbling”) mean, and what does it not mean?	It means secure footing — the final, irreversible fall is not available to the kept. It does not mean believers never sin; 1 John 1:9 provides the remedy for those stumbles.
What does “make you stand… blameless” tell us about who does the work?	The verb is causative: God makes them stand. The blamelessness is His accomplishment, like the sacrificial animal brought without blemish.
What does *agalliasis* add to the picture of the last day?	It is exuberant, overflowing joy — not solemn relief. Possibly shared by both the believers and God.
What is the difference between the two pairs of attributes in v. 25?	Glory and majesty describe what God is. Dominion and authority describe what He wields — might and right.
How does the bookend structure of vv. 1 and 24 shape the whole letter?	The warnings and instructions all live inside two declarations of divine keeping. The contending is the contending of kept people.

Part 2 — Study Questions

1. Where do you notice yourself relying on your own grip rather than on His ability? What would it look like to rest the weight on Him?

> *Leader note: See Commentary I — aptaistous and the rope.*

2. What does it do for you to know God *makes* you stand blameless before His glory?

> *Leader note: See Commentary II.A–B.*

3. How does the Free Grace reading of v. 24 differ from the Reformed reading, and why does it matter for assurance?

> *Leader note: See Commentary I — Berkhof, Schreiner and Caneday, Wilkin.*

4. How does the thought of “great joy” at the last day change how you carry the weight of contending now?

> *Leader note: See Commentary II.C — the prodigal’s father.*

5. **How does the bookend of vv. 1 and 24 help you read the warnings of Jude differently?**

> *Leader note: See Commentary Conclusion.*

Part 3 — Passage Summary

Verse(s)	Theme	Key Truth
v. 24a	God's ability	He is able to keep from the final stumble. Ability is the first name for God here.
v. 24b	The standing	God makes believers stand in the presence of His glory — His doing.
v. 24b	Blameless	Perfect acceptability — His accomplishment, not their record.
v. 24b	Great joy	A celebration, not a solemn verdict.
v. 25	The doxology	Glory and majesty (what He is); dominion and authority (what He wields) — forever.
vv. 1 ↔ 24	The bookends	The whole letter is framed by God's keeping.

⑤ APPLICATION

Closes the study · Personal & corporate

Application 1 — Rest the Weight on His Ability

Jude 24a

Drawn from Commentary I. Key terms: dynamenō, aptaistous. FGR: Wilkin, Confident in Christ.

The doxology's first word is "able." After twenty-three verses of urgency, the last word is not "try harder" but "He is able." You can contend, build, and keep yourself in God's love because the outcome does not rest on your grip. There is a difference between contending from victory and contending for it.

Reflection: Where are you treating the outcome of your Christian life as dependent on your faithfulness more than on His ability?

Practical Step: For one week, begin each day's prayer with "To Him who is able." Let your first words be praise for His ability, then bring your need.

Application 2 — You Will Be Presented Blameless

Jude 24b

Drawn from Commentary II.A–B. Key terms: stēsai, amōmous.

Blameless is the word of a perfect sacrificial offering. God will make His people stand before His glory, and they will stand blameless. This is for the wound that undermines your confidence before God: He will bring you through it.

Reflection: Name the weakness or failure that most undermines your confidence before God. Sit with the word "blameless." What does it do to the way you carry that failure?

Practical Step: Read Ephesians 5:25–27 with Jude 24. Write one sentence connecting Paul's and Jude's picture of the church's final state.

Application 3 — The Joy Is Great

Jude 24b

Drawn from Commentary II.C. Key term: agalliasis.

Communities that spend years contending for the faith can start to associate faithfulness with endurance and effort. Jude's last word on the subject is not effort. It is great joy. The end of all the contending is a celebration planned before the contending began.

Reflection: As a group: does your community associate faithfulness more with endurance or with joy?

Practical Step: Close this study by reading Jude 24–25 aloud together as a doxology. Let the last word be praise.

Application 4 — The Bookends Hold

Jude 1; 24

Drawn from Commentary Conclusion.

Called, beloved, kept (v. 1). Able to keep, able to make you stand blameless, with great joy (v. 24). Everything between is held inside these two declarations. A community that has taken in the bookends contends from confidence, not from anxiety.

Reflection: Having finished the series, which study changed most how you see your standing before God? Which changed most how you see the threat of false teaching?

Practical Step: Write Jude 1b and Jude 24 on one card. Put it where you will see it daily for a month.

End of Study · Jude 24–25